



ALTHOUGH LIONEL MESSI HAS YET TO SCORE IN THIS EDITION, HE PROVIDED AN EXCELLENT ASSIST IN ARGENTINA'S OPENING MATCH AGAINST CANADA

On the money: Lautaro Martinez (right) has been Argentina's hero in the group stage with four goals in three matches. AP

score in this edition, he provided an excellent assist in Argentina's opening match against Canada.

He did not play in the final group game against Peru, with Scaloni stating that Messi was rested due to a minor knock on his leg, which Messi described as "not serious," and



also because the Argentine captain played the first two matches with a fever.

Lautaro Martinez has been the *Albiceleste's* hero in the group stage, scoring four goals in three matches.

Uruguay looking strong under Marcelo Bielsa

Amidst all the hype surrounding

Argentina, Marcelo Bielsa's Uruguay has flexed its muscles, making a strong case for being favourites to clinch the title for a record 16th time in Copa America 2024.

Transformed under Bielsa's heavy-duty playing style, *La Celeste* boasts serious talent with players like Darwin Nunez, Federico Valverde, and Facundo Pellistri, and looks more menacing with the experience of Luis Suarez.

Uruguay began its campaign with a 3-1 win against Panama and followed it up with a 5-0 thrashing of Bolivia.

With full points from three matches, it has secured a place in the quarterfinals as the Group C topper.

Bielsa's men concluded the group stage with a 1-0 win against USA, knocking the host out of the tournament.

Kendry Paez, a new phenomenon

When a major club like Chelsea secures a pre-contract signing for a 16-year-old, it shows the player's exceptional potential. Ecuador's Kendry Paez came into the spotlight after becoming the youngest player

Marching on: Uruguay possesses serious talent in players like Federico Valverde and Darwin Nunez (first and second from left). AP

The 48th edition of the Copa America began on June 14, with the United States hosting the tournament. Here are five key highlights from the event so far:

Argentina through to quarterfinals

Defending champion Argentina not only secured a place in the quarterfinals but did so in style by winning all three group matches. Additionally, Lionel Scaloni's men did not concede a single goal throughout the group stages.

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